



CAPITAL MARKETS • INSIGHT

Mid-Year IPO Market Outlook, What Issuers Should Be Preparing Now

Camila Torres • Chair, Capital Markets, Partner

Every reopening window rewards the issuers who did the unglamorous readiness work while the market was closed, not the ones who start preparing once it reopens.

The readiness gap is bigger than most boards realize

Financial controls, board composition, and public-company governance all take longer to stand up than founders expect. Eighteen months is a realistic runway from a standing start, not the six months many boards are currently budgeting.

“Eighteen months is a realistic IPO readiness runway from a standing start, not six.”

Disclosure expectations have shifted since the last cycle

Risk factor language that was acceptable three years ago now reads as thin to underwriters and to the market. Climate, AI, and cybersecurity disclosures in particular have moved from optional color to something diligence teams actively probe.

Pricing discipline matters more than speed to market

The issuers who priced conservatively and traded up in the last reopening did far better, on every metric that matters a year out, than the ones who pushed for the highest number the book would bear.

If a listing is realistically on your two-year horizon, the governance and disclosure work should be starting now, not once a banker tells you the window is open.

WRITTEN BY

Camila Torres

Chair, Capital Markets, Partner

Have a matter like this?

Book a consultation and we'll connect you with the right team.

sterlingcross.law

© Sterling & Cross Law Firm. This publication is provided for general informational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Reading this document does not create an attorney-client relationship. For advice on your specific situation, please contact us directly at hello@sterlingcross.law.